

Customized

Tuesday, January 20, 2026 2:13 PM

Excellent — this is exactly the right moment to **engineer the schedule**, not just "study harder."

Below is a **time-minimized, morning-only, recitation-driven execution plan** that:

- Keeps **Network+ trivial**
- Coexists with **Security+**, **Senior Design**, and **graduation**
- Accounts for **Japan travel (Feb 26 - Mar 13)**
- Uses **short, high-yield sessions** instead of brute-force study
- Leverages **recitation + spaced reinforcement** (MIT-style)

I'll first explain the **strategy**, then give you a **concrete weekly schedule**, then show **how travel weeks work**, and finally how **Security+ piggybacks**.

1 Core Strategy (Why This Works)

Constraints (we design *around* these)

- Morning classes only
- ~**1.5 hours per session**
- Prefer **2 structured sessions/week**
- Multiple parallel priorities
- Graduation → **low cognitive overhead**

Solution

We use a **3-layer system**:

Layer	Purpose	Time
Lecture (L)	Introduce + structure	1.5 hr
Recitation (R)	Make it trivial	1.5 hr
Passive Reinforcement	Zero-stress absorption	Asynchronous

You **do not** re-read the book cover-to-cover.

You **do not** grind random questions.

You **do** explain concepts aloud, repeatedly, with intent.

2 Weekly Meeting Pattern (Default)

We meet **2x per week**, mornings only.

A **third optional "micro-block"** is asynchronous.

Default Week (Non-Travel)

Day	Type	Duration	Purpose
Monday	Lecture (L)	1.5 hr	New chapters & mental models
Wednesday	Recitation (R)	1.5 hr	Explain → apply → trivialize
Friday (optional)	Passive	20-40 min	Video / light reading

Friday is **never heavy**. It protects graduation bandwidth.

3 What Happens in Each Session (Very Important)

🗓 Monday — Lecture (1.5 hr)

Goal:

You leave knowing *what matters* and *why*, not details.

Structure

1. 10 min — "Why this exists on the exam"
2. 40 min — Conceptual walkthrough (diagrams, flows)
3. 20 min — Failure modes & traps
4. 20 min — Security+ overlap callouts

🔴 **Rule:**

If it can't be explained in **plain English**, it's not learned.

🗓 Wednesday — Recitation (1.5 hr)

Goal:

Make the exam feel *obvious*.

Structure

5. You explain concepts **out loud**
6. We reverse roles (you teach → I probe)
7. Scenario attacks:
 - "What breaks if..."
 - "Why not the other answer?"
8. Rapid-fire exam logic (not memorization)

🔴 **Rule:**

If you can teach it tired, you pass it rested.

🗓 Friday — Passive Reinforcement (Optional)

Zero pressure.

- Professor Messer
- Short RFC summaries
- Whiteboard-style YouTube explanations

No notes required.

This is *background radiation* learning.

4 Full Weekly Allocation (Network+ Only)

Activity	Weekly Time
Lecture	1.5 hr
Recitation	1.5 hr
Passive	~0.5 hr
Total	~3.5 hr/week

That's it.

Anything more would *hurt* your other priorities.

5 Travel-Aware Plan (Feb 26 – Mar 13 🇯🇵)

These **2 weeks are special**.

During Japan

- ✗ No lectures
- ✗ No exams
- ✗ No heavy labs

What *does* happen

Activity	Time	When
Passive video	15–20 min	Flights / evenings
Audio explanations	Optional	Transit
Zero guilt	Mandatory	Always

🔥 Why this works

- You're past foundational learning by then
- This becomes **memory consolidation**
- Jet lag actually helps recall spacing

6 Revised Semester Flow (High Level)

Phase 1 — Foundations (Weeks 1–7)

- Heavy conceptual work
- Subnetting, routing, switching
- This is where recitation matters most

Phase 2 — Midterm → Travel (Weeks 8–10)

- Midterm **before travel**
- Travel weeks = passive only

Phase 3 — Security + Ops (Weeks 11–16)

- Security chapters overlap with **Security+**
- Network availability, tools, troubleshooting
- Low stress, high familiarity

Phase 4 — Final (Week 17)

- You are **already passing**
- Final = confirmation

7 Security+ Integration (Time-Neutral)

We **do not add extra sessions**.

Instead:

- Every **security chapter**:
- Call out **Security+ equivalents**
- Same concepts, different framing
- Result:
Network+ security weeks → **Security+ pre-study**

🔥 Net effect:

- Network+ study **reduces** Security+ workload
- No double studying

8 Senior Design Protection Rules

These are **non-negotiable safeguards**:

- No Network+ work after **11:30 AM**
- No "catch-up marathons"
- If Senior Design spikes → Network+ goes passive that week
- Passing > perfect

This is how you graduate *clean*.

9 What I Recommend Next (Choose One)

I can now:

- 📅 **Generate a dated calendar** (actual Mondays/Wednesdays)
- 🔧 Build the **exact recitation prompts** per week
- 🗂️ Curate **short video lists** per chapter group
- 📊 Map **Network+ → Security+ overlap table**
- 📝 Design a **no-stress midterm format**

Tell me which one you want first — this plan is ready to execute.

